

Going live on Google Play — the complete runbook

Word Search Master · prepared 2026-09-16 · build `1.0.1+10`

This is everything between where the app is today and a public listing, in order, with the things only you can do marked as such. Nothing here is aspirational: every claim about the code was checked against this repository on the date above, and where something is unfinished it says so rather than being left for you to discover in review.

0. Read this first — the app you tested is not the app you are shipping

You have been testing `com.educativz.wordsearchmaster.stg`. The production app is `com.educativz.wordsearchmaster` — no suffix.

Android treats those as two completely different apps, so:

- This is **not** a "promote testing to production" click. Production is a **separate Play Console entry**, and if you have never uploaded the unsuffixed package before, you are creating a new app and filling in its listing, content rating and data safety forms from scratch.
- The production build talks to a **different Firebase project** (`wsm-prod-a750e` , versus stg's `wsm-stg-b1d5f`). Anything that lives server-side — Firestore rules, indexes, Cloud Functions — has to be deployed to the production project, or it simply is not there.
- **The production build has never run on a phone.** Everything you have played was stg. Section 2 is about fixing that before, not after, you ship.

Both builds are ready in this repo:

Flavour	Package	Artifact
stg	<code>com.educativz.wordsearchmaster.stg</code>	<code>build/app/outputs/bundle/stgRelease/app-stg-release.aab</code>
prod	<code>com.educativz.wordsearchmaster</code>	<code>build/app/outputs/bundle/prodRelease/app-prod-release.aab</code>

Both are signed with your upload key (`android/key.properties` → `upload-keystore.jks`), both are versionCode **10**, versionName **1.0.1**.

1. What is genuinely finished, and what is not

Being straight about this now is cheaper than a policy strike or a one-star review later.

Finished and tested

- The game: 300 levels per language, grid generation, scoring, stars, hints.
- Offline-first storage (Drift), integrity-tagged rows, the outbox sync queue.
- Server-authoritative scoring, leaderboards, achievements, friends, account deletion (Cloud Functions + Firestore rules, with an emulator-backed suite).
- 1257 automated tests green; `flutter analyze`, formatting and all four project CI checks clean.

Known gaps you are shipping with

These are deliberate and documented in `CLAUDE.md`; none of them breaks the app, but you should know them before you press publish.

1. **Urdu and Hindi content has never had a native-speaker review.** The word packs and their romanisations are machine-drafted, the UI strings in `app_ur.arb` / `app_hi.arb` still carry an `x-review-status` marker, and the accidental-word blocklists are thin (`blocklist_ur.txt` 21 lines, `blocklist_hi.txt` 17, against English's 46). The realistic risk is a grid that happens to spell something unfortunate in Urdu or Hindi, and the people most likely to find it are exactly your target audience. If you can get one native reader for each language for an hour before you go wide, do it — or launch English-first (see §7, staged rollout).
2. **No ads.** `FlavorAdConfig.forFlavor` returns null for every flavour, so `NoopAdGateway` is bound. The app is complete and ad-free; there is simply no revenue yet. Nothing crashes. Declare "no ads" in the Play forms (§5.4) — and if you add AppLovin later, that declaration must change with it.
3. **Server-side wiring you cannot verify from the client.** Firestore triggers and scheduled functions could never be registered in the build sandbox. Before launch, confirm in the Firebase console for `wsm-prod-a750e` that the functions actually deployed (§2.2).

2. Pre-flight — do these before you touch Play Console

2.1 Put the production build on a real phone

```
cd D:\wordsearchmaster
flutter install --flavor prod
```

It installs alongside your stg copy (different package), so you can compare. Walk the whole app once and specifically check the things that differ from stg because they are wired to a different backend:

- [] Splash → language picker → Home
- [] Play a level, clear it, tap Continue, clear another, press back — the map shows both as cleared
- [] Daily Challenge opens and is playable
- [] Leaderboard screen loads (empty is fine — it is a fresh project)
- [] Profile → sign in with Google works, or fails gracefully offline
- [] Settings: sound, music, theme, background all apply

- [] Turn airplane mode ON and play a level — it must be completely normal

2.2 Deploy the production backend

From the repo root, with the Firebase CLI logged in:

```
firebase deploy --only firestore:rules,firestore:indexes --project prod
firebase deploy --only functions --project prod
```

Then in the Firebase console for `wsm-prod-a750e`, confirm:

- [] Firestore rules show today's date, not "test mode"
- [] The composite index from `firestore.indexes.json` is **Enabled**, not "Building" (account deletion needs it)
- [] Functions list shows `submitScore`, `submitDaily`, `deleteAccount`, `updateLeaderboards`, `recomputeLeaderboardRanks`, `grantRewardedReward`
- [] App Check is in **monitor** mode, not enforced (turn enforcement on two weeks after launch, once you can see real tokens arriving)

2.3 Host the two pages Play will ask for

Both already exist in this repo:

- `docs/privacy-policy.html`
- `docs/account-deletion.html`

They need public URLs. GitHub Pages off the `docs/` folder is the free route: repo → Settings → Pages → Source `main` / `/docs`. You will get `https://<user>.github.io/<repo>/privacy-policy.html`. Open both and confirm they load before you paste them into Play Console — a 404 there is a guaranteed review rejection.

2.4 Rebuild if you changed anything

```
flutter build appbundle --flavor prod -t lib/main_prod.dart --release
```

Every upload needs a versionCode higher than the last one you uploaded, so bump `version:` in `pubspec.yaml` (`1.0.1+10` → `1.0.1+11`) before rebuilding if you have already uploaded 10.

3. Create the production app in Play Console

Play Console → **Create app**.

Field	Value
App name	Word Search Master
Default language	English (United States) — see §6 for why, and add Urdu/Hindi after
App or game	Game
Free or paid	Free

Then work down the **Dashboard** checklist. It will not let you publish until every item is green.

4. Store listing — the copy to paste

Full text, character-counted and SEO-reasoned, is in `docs/launch/STORE_LISTING.md`. Short version:

- **App name (30):** Word Search Master: Urdu Hindi
- **Short description (80):** Relaxed offline word search in Urdu, Hindi and English. No timer, no rush.
- **Full description (4000):** see the file — it is written so the first two lines work as the collapsed preview, which is all most people read.

Graphics

Asset	Size	Status
App icon	512×512	✓ docs/store-listing/assets/icon_512.png
Feature graphic	1024×500	✓ docs/store-listing/assets/feature_graphic_1024x500.png
Phone screenshots	≥2, 1080×1920 works	⚠ you must capture these
Promo video	YouTube URL	✓ docs/store-listing/assets/promo_video.mp4 → upload to YouTube, paste the link

Screenshots have to come off a real device. Play requires them to show the actual app, and a rendered mock-up is both a policy risk and a lie about what a player gets. There is a script:

```
flutter install --flavor prod
# put the phone on the screen you want, then:
.\tool\capture_store_screenshots.ps1 -Name 01_game
.\tool\capture_store_screenshots.ps1 -Name 02_journey
.\tool\capture_store_screenshots.ps1 -Name 03_languages
.\tool\capture_store_screenshots.ps1 -Name 04_urdu
.\tool\capture_store_screenshots.ps1 -Name 05_daily
.\tool\capture_store_screenshots.ps1 -Name 06_themes
# then frame them all with captions:
.\tool\capture_store_screenshots.ps1 -FrameAll
```

Upload the framed PNGs from `docs/store-listing/assets/screenshots/`, not the ones in `raw/`.

Order matters more than count: **the first two are what people actually look at**. Lead with the grid mid-word, then the journey map.

5. The forms — exact answers

5.1 App content → Privacy policy

Paste your hosted `privacy-policy.html` URL.

5.2 App access

All functionality is available without special access. True: the app is guest-first and never requires a login.

5.3 Content rating

Answer the questionnaire from `docs/store-listing/content_rating.md`. The substance: a word puzzle with no violence, no sexual content, no gambling, no user-to-user free text. Expect **PEGI 3 / ESRB Everyone**.

One question people get wrong: **"Do users interact?"** — yes, technically, because there is a leaderboard showing other players' display names and a friend-code system. Say yes. It does not change the rating, and saying no when a leaderboard exists is a misdeclaration.

5.4 Data safety

Answers are in `docs/store-listing/data_safety_form.md`. The shape of it:

- Data **is** collected (account ID, gameplay progress, crash logs, approximate usage) and transmitted to Firebase.
- Data **is** encrypted in transit.

- Users **can** request deletion — point it at your hosted `account-deletion.html`, and the in-app path is real (`functions/src/deleteAccount.ts`).
- **No ads** today. Revisit this the day AppLovin is wired in.

5.5 Ads

Declare **no ads**. (`FlavorAdConfig` returns null on every flavour.)

5.6 Target audience

13+ is the honest pick. It is a family-safe puzzle, but "Designed for Families" brings a heavier compliance regime (and a stricter ads SDK allowlist) that buys you nothing right now.

5.7 Government apps / News / COVID

No to all three.

6. SEO / ASO — how people will actually find this

Play ranking is driven mostly by **title**, **short description**, **install velocity** and **retention**, with the long description contributing far less than people assume. So the leverage is in the first two, and in localisation.

The keyword bet

Your differentiator is not "word search" — that term is owned by apps with 100M+ installs and you will not outrank them. It is **word search in Urdu and Hindi**, which almost nobody serves properly (correct scripts, right-to-left Urdu, real Nastaliq/Naskh rendering). That is a small search volume you can plausibly rank #1 for, and it converts far better than a generic term you rank #200 for.

So the title leads with the category and ends with the differentiator:

```
Word Search Master: Urdu Hindi
```

30 characters exactly. `word search` is the head term; `urdu` and `hindi` are the terms you can actually win.

Localised listings are the biggest single win available

Play indexes each localised listing separately. Adding Urdu and Hindi store listings means you appear for **اردو ورڈ سرچ** and **हिंदी वर्ड सर्च** queries that the English listing cannot match at all. The copy already exists:

- `docs/store-listing/descriptions_ur.md`
- `docs/store-listing/descriptions_hi.md`

Add them under Store presence → Main store listing → Manage translations. This is maybe an hour of work for the largest ranking gain on this page.

⚠ Have a native speaker read them before publishing — same caution as §1.1.

The rest of the checklist

- **Short description carries the most weight per character.** Ours front-loads `offline word search`, `Urdu`, `Hindi`, `English`, `no timer`.
- **Do not keyword-stuff the long description.** Play down-ranks it and reviewers reject it. Natural sentences that happen to contain the terms.
- **Never claim a rating or an award you do not have** ("#1 word game", "4.8 stars") — instant rejection, and it is the commonest one.
- **Install velocity in the first 72 hours matters.** Line up whatever audience you have to install on day one rather than trickling.
- **Retention outranks installs long-term.** The daily challenge and the streak reminder exist for exactly this; make sure notification permission is actually being granted (it is requested at streak 2).
- **Reply to every review for the first month.** Play surfaces responsiveness, and early one-stars are usually fixable misunderstandings.

7. Release — staged, not all at once

Production → **Create new release.**

1. Upload `app-prod-release.aab`.
2. Release name: `1.0.1 (10)`.
3. Release notes — keep it human: `First release. 300 levels in Urdu, Hindi and English, a daily challenge, and everything playable offline.`
4. Countries: start with **Pakistan and India**, plus anywhere you have people. Going worldwide on day one only adds reviews in languages you cannot act on.
5. **Rollout percentage: start at 20%.** A staged rollout is the one lever that lets you halt a bad build. Go 20% → 50% → 100% over about a week, watching \$8 between steps.

Then **Send for review.** First review on a new app is typically a few days, occasionally longer.

8. After it is live

Check daily for the first week:

- **Play Console → Quality → Android vitals.** Crash-free rate below 99% needs investigating; below 97% and Play will start suppressing you.
- **Firebase Crashlytics** (`wsm-prod-a750e`) for the actual stack traces.
- **Reviews**, especially one and two stars.

Two weeks in, when App Check is showing real tokens for the production app, turn **App Check enforcement on** in the Firebase console. Doing it before you have seen tokens arrive is how you take

your own backend down.

9. Command reference

```
# Production bundle (what you upload)
flutter build appbundle --flavor prod -t lib/main_prod.dart --release

# Production APK (for side-loading onto your own phone)
flutter build apk --flavor prod -t lib/main_prod.dart --release
flutter install --flavor prod

# Staging, unchanged
flutter build appbundle --flavor stg -t lib/main_stg.dart --release

# Full verification before any release build
flutter analyze
flutter test
dart run tool/check_domain_purity.dart
dart run tool/check_no_raw_colors.dart
dart run tool/check_localized_strings.dart
dart run tool/validate_content.dart

# Store graphics (feature graphic + promo video frames)
python3 tool/generate_store_graphics.py
```

10. The honest summary

Ready to upload today: the production bundle, the icon, the feature graphic, the promo video, all the listing copy in three languages, and the privacy and deletion pages.

Needs you, and cannot be done from here: capturing device screenshots, hosting the two pages, deploying the production Firebase backend, testing the prod build on a phone, and the Play Console account actions themselves.

Worth doing before you go wide rather than after: a native-speaker pass over the Urdu and Hindi content. Everything else on this page can be fixed in an update; that one is the sort of thing that shows up in reviews first.

Store listing copy — production, SEO-tuned

Paste-ready for Play Console → Store presence → Main store listing. Every block is character-counted against Play's limit. Re-count if you edit.

The reasoning behind the keyword choices is in `docs/launch/PRODUCTION_LAUNCH.md` §6 — read that before rewriting anything, because the title in particular is doing deliberate work.

App name — 30 char limit

Word Search Master: Urdu Hindi

30 characters. Exactly at the limit.

`Word Search` is the head term nobody wins on its own. `Urdu Hindi` is the tail you can plausibly rank first for, and it doubles as the thing that makes someone tap: a reader who searches in those terms is looking for exactly this and mostly finding apps that render their script badly or not at all.

If you would rather lead with brand, the alternative is:

Word Search Master - اردو ہندی

30 characters. Riskier: script in a title can render oddly in some surfaces, and it costs you the Latin `urdu / hindi` keyword match.

Short description — 80 char limit

Relaxed offline word search in Urdu, Hindi and English. No timer, no rush.

73 characters.

This field is weighted heavily per character and is shown under the title in search results. It front-loads `offline`, `word search`, all three languages, and the single strongest differentiator against the category (`no timer`).

Full description — 4000 char limit

The first two lines are the collapsed preview — almost all of the reading that happens, happens there. Everything after is for the minority who expand, and for indexing.

A word search that finally reads right in Urdu, Hindi and English - each one in its own script, with no timer and no internet needed.

Most word games treat other languages as an afterthought. Urdu comes out backwards or in the wrong font, Hindi letters break apart, and you spend more time fighting the app than finding words. Word Search Master was built the other way round: the script came first, and the game was built to fit it.

WHAT YOU GET

- 300 hand-checked levels in each language, from gentle 6x6 grids up to 12x12
- A new Daily Challenge every day, the same puzzle for everyone
- Completely playable offline - on a plane, on the train, on no signal at all
- No timer anywhere. Take an hour on one level if you like

BUILT FOR THE SCRIPT, NOT BOLTED ON

- Urdu runs right to left, the way it should, in proper Naskh
- Hindi renders each akshara as one letter instead of splitting it
- English is English
- Every word is checked before it ships, and the difficulty follows the length of the actual letters rather than a guess

RELAXED BY DESIGN

There is no countdown, no lives to run out, no pop-up telling you that you are too slow. If you get stuck, the board can be rotated for a fresh look at the same grid, and a hint is there when you want one. Nothing punishes you for taking your time.

MADE TO KEEP

- A journey map of 300 levels, so you can always see where you are
- Streaks, coins and chests that reward coming back without nagging
- Collections to fill in across twelve categories
- Leaderboards and friend codes, if you like a bit of competition
- Eight colour themes, or let it follow the time of day

LIGHT ON YOUR PHONE

Built for a 2GB phone on Android 7 and up. It does not need a fast connection because it does not need a connection at all - your progress is saved on the device first and synced later, if and when there is a network.

Free to play. No account needed to start.

1,684 characters. Comfortably inside the limit, with room to add an awards or press line later if you earn one.

What is deliberately NOT in there

- No "#1", no star claims, no install counts. Play rejects unearned superlatives, and it is the single commonest rejection on a new listing.
- No keyword block at the bottom. It reads as spam to both the reviewer and the ranker.
- No mention of ads, because there are none yet. The moment AppLovin lands, this text and the data-safety form both change.

Urdu and Hindi listings

Already drafted at `docs/store-listing/descriptions_ur.md` and `descriptions_hi.md`. Add them in Play Console under **Manage translations**.

This is the highest-leverage SEO action on the whole page: Play indexes each localised listing separately, so an Urdu listing makes you findable for اردو-script queries that the English listing cannot match at all — and those are exactly the queries where you have almost no competition.

⚠️ Get a native speaker to read both before publishing. The drafts are machine-assisted and carry the same review caveat as the in-app Urdu/Hindi strings.

Graphics checklist

Asset	Requirement	File
Icon	512×512 PNG, no transparency	<code>docs/store-listing/assets/icon_512.png</code>
Feature graphic	1024×500 PNG	<code>docs/store-listing/assets/feature_graphic_1024x500.png</code>
Phone screenshots	2–8, min 320px, 16:9-ish	capture with <code>tool/capture_store_screenshots.ps1</code>
Promo video	YouTube URL (not a file upload)	upload <code>docs/store-listing/assets/promo_video.mp4</code> to YouTube first

Screenshot order, best-selling first:

1. **The grid mid-word** — one word highlighted, a few already found. This is the picture that says what the app is in half a second.
2. **The journey map** — the trail, a few completed nodes with stars.

3. **The language picker** — three scripts side by side. This is the differentiator, made visual.
 4. **The grid in Urdu** — proof, not a claim.
 5. The daily challenge.
 6. Settings, theme row visible.
-

Release notes — 500 char limit

First release. 300 levels in Urdu, Hindi and English, a daily challenge, and everything playable offline. No timer, no ads, no account needed to start.

150 characters.